

- Foreign Policy of Pakistan Basic concepts and trends:

Major determinants of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

Geo-political and geo-strategic position of Pakistan

FOREIGN POLICY AND ITS DETERMINANTS

1. What is Foreign Policy?

- Foreign policy is the way a country interacts with other countries and international organizations to achieve its goals. OR
- Foreign policy refers to the strategies and decisions a state adopts to interact with other nations, international organizations, and global actors to achieve its national interests. Pakistan's foreign policy is shaped by a complex interaction of historical, geographical, ideological, economic, and political factors.
- ***"Foreign policy is the system of activities evolved by communities for changing the behavior of other states and for adjusting their own activities to the international environment."*** George Modelski
- **For example:**
- **Why it matters:** It helps a nation secure its borders, grow economically, and build global relationships.
- **Example for Pakistan:** Seeking aid from the U.S. in its early years to stabilize the economy and military. For Pakistan, foreign policy ensures:
 - Defense against external threats (like India).
 - Economic development (e.g., China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)).
 - Support for global Islamic causes (e.g., Palestine, Kashmir).

2.Determinants of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

- Several factors influence how Pakistan shapes its foreign relations: **Geography: Strategic Location:**
- Pakistan lies at the crossroads of South Asia, Central Asia, and the Middle East. Its nearness to major powers (China, India, and Iran) and regions of strategic importance (the Arabian Sea and Persian Gulf) profoundly influences its foreign policy.
- **Border Dynamics:** Sharing borders with India, Afghanistan, Iran, and China affects relations, particularly in addressing security, trade, and regional cooperation. Example: Its location made it critical for U.S. operations during the Afghan War.
- **Historical Context:**
- **Partition Legacy:** The partition of British India created unresolved issues, especially Kashmir, fueling tensions with India.
- **Cold War Alliances:** Pakistan aligned with the U.S. during the Cold War, joining pacts like SEATO and CENTO to counterbalance India's tilt toward the Soviet Union.
- **Early reliance on U.S. aid shaped Cold War alliances.** Example: Pakistan joined SEATO and CENTO in the 1950s to secure Western support.
- **Ideology:**
- Pakistan's creation as a homeland for Muslims gives it an ideological commitment to Islamic solidarity
- Example: Hosting the 1974 Islamic Summit under Zulfikar Ali Bhutto to unite Muslim nations.
- This is reflected in its leadership role within the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) and its efforts to champion causes such as Palestine and Kashmir.

Economic Factors:

- **Economic Dependence:** Pakistan relies heavily on foreign aid and loans, particularly from the IMF, World Bank, and friendly nations like China and Saudi Arabia.
- **Trade and Investment:** Initiatives like the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) aim to boost economic growth but also shape foreign relations.

Security and Defense India as a Perceived Threat:

- Pakistan's security policies are heavily influenced by its rivalry with India, particularly over Kashmir and military build-ups.
- **Terrorism and Counterterrorism:** Post-9/11, Pakistan became a frontline state in the War on Terror, significantly impacting its relations with the U.S., Afghanistan, and global power

Regional Dynamics:

- **Afghanistan:** Stability in Afghanistan is crucial for Pakistan, both for its security and for fostering regional connectivity.
- **China:** Pakistan's strategic partnership with China is central to its foreign policy, driven by economic cooperation and balancing Indian influence.
- **India:** The unresolved Kashmir dispute and frequent border tensions dominate Pakistan-India relations.

Global Factors:

- **Role of Major Powers:** Relations with the U.S., China, Russia, and the EU are shaped by economic, military, and political interests.
- **Global Challenges:** Issues like climate change, global trade, and terrorism influence Pakistan's engagement with multilateral forums.
- **Public Opinion and Domestic Politics :** The views of political parties, media, and civil society play a role in shaping foreign policy priorities. Internal stability, governance challenges, and economic performance directly impact Pakistan's ability to pursue effective foreign relations.
- **Technological and Nuclear Factors:** Pakistan's nuclear capability is both a limitation and a factor shaping its global image and strategic partnerships.

3- Objectives of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

- **1. Safeguard Sovereignty:** Protect its independence and territorial integrity. Example: Strengthening its nuclear program in response to India's nuclear advancements.
- **2. Promote Islamic Solidarity:** Unite Muslim countries. Example: Leadership in the OIC and advocating for Palestine.
- **3. Foster Economic Growth:** Secure trade and investment. Example: Partnerships with China through CPEC to boost infrastructure and trade.
- **Resolve Kashmir Issue:** Advocate for Kashmir's self-determination. Example: Consistently raising the issue in the UN.

4-Key Features of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

- 1.Relations with Muslim States: Improving ties with Saudi Arabia, Turkey, UAE, and Iran. Supporting Muslim causes like Palestine and opposing Islamophobia globally.
- 2.Close Partnership with China: Cooperation through CPEC and broader strategic alignment in the Belt and Road Initiative. Diplomatic support for each other on global issues.
- 3.Engagement with the U.S.: Historically unstable relations, from Cold War alliances to post-9/11 cooperation. Challenges due to differing priorities, such as on Afghanistan and counterterrorism.
- 4.Focus on Kashmir: Consistent diplomatic efforts to highlight the Kashmir issue in international forums, such as the UN.
- 5.Regional Cooperation: o Engaging in regional organizations like SAARC, ECO, and SCO for economic and political cooperation.

5.ChallengesFacingPakistan'sForeignPolicy

- 1.Economic Instability: Heavy dependence on foreign aid limits autonomy in decision-making.
- 2.Geopolitical Rivalries: Managing tensions with India, Afghanistan, and balancing relations with global powers remains a persistent challenge.
- 3.Global Perceptions: Addressing narratives around terrorism and improving Pakistan's image internationally is an ongoing concern.

• **History of Pakistan's Foreign policy Since 1947 Early Years (1947-1953): Challenges of a New Country**

- **Partition and Issues:** Pakistan was formed in 1947 and faced big problems like resource shortages, managing refugees, and disputes with India, especially over Kashmir.
- **Focus on Security:** The 1948 Kashmir conflict made defense and security a top priority.
- **Looking for Help:** Pakistan first stayed neutral but later sought Western countries' support for military and economic help.

Alignment with the West (1954-1962)

- **Joining Alliances:** Pakistan joined U.S.-led groups (SEATO and CENTO) to get military aid and counter the Soviet Union.
- **Closer to the U.S.:** The U.S.-Pakistan relationship grew, but it was mostly about benefits for both sides.
- **Neighbor Issues:** Supporting the West strained Pakistan's relations with neighbors like India and Afghanistan.

Wars and Isolation (1963-1971)

- **1965 War with India:** The war worsened ties with India and caused the U.S. to cut military aid to Pakistan.
- **Friendship with China:** Pakistan strengthened its relations with China for military and economic cooperation.
- **1971 War:** Pakistan lost East Pakistan (now Bangladesh), exposing weaknesses in foreign and domestic policies.

Non-Alignment and Islamic Solidarity (1972-1977)

- New Direction: Under Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, Pakistan reduced dependence on the West and focused on building ties with Muslim countries.
- Islamic Summit (1974): Pakistan hosted this event to lead the Muslim world.
- Closer to China: Bhutto made the China-Pakistan partnership stronger.

Cold War Frontline State (1979-1989)

- Afghan War: The Soviet Union invaded Afghanistan, making Pakistan a key U.S. ally. Pakistan supported Afghan fighters (Mujahideen).
- U.S. Aid: Pakistan received military and economic help but faced issues due to its nuclear program.
- Zia's Era: General Zia-ul-Haq emphasized Islamic values and Pakistan's role in the Muslim world.

Post-Cold War Challenges (1990-2001)

- U.S. Sanctions: The Pressler Amendment restricted U.S. aid due to Pakistan's nuclear program.
- Kashmir Tensions: Pakistan supported militants in Kashmir, worsening ties with India.
- Nuclear Tests (1998): In response to India's tests, Pakistan also conducted nuclear tests, leading to global sanctions.

War on Terror and Post-9/11 Era (2001-2008)

- Key U.S. Ally: After 9/11, Pakistan joined the U.S. in the War on Terror and received significant aid.
- Instability: The war caused rising terrorism and public anger over U.S. drone strikes.
- Criticism: Pakistan was accused of supporting militant groups while fighting them.

Strategic Realignments (2008-2022)

- Closer to China: Pakistan built strong ties with China through projects like the China- Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC).
- India-Pakistan Issues: Tensions increased after events like the Pulwama attack (2019) and India's changes in Kashmir (Article 370).
- Afghanistan: Pakistan helped in U.S.-Taliban talks but faced challenges after the Taliban took over in 2021.
- Balancing Relations: Pakistan tried to balance its ties with the U.S., China, Saudi Arabia, and Iran while dealing with economic problems.

Key Themes in Pakistan's Foreign Policy

- 1.Focus on Security: Relations are driven by fears of India and the Kashmir issue.
- 2.Building Alliances: Partnering with the U.S., China, and Muslim countries.
- 3.Economic Dependency: Relying on foreign aid and loans for development.
- 4.Regional Tensions: Struggles with neighbors overshadow regional cooperation.
- 5.Global Adjustments: Adapting to changes in global power, especially U.S.-China competition.

Summary of Key Themes

- Security-Centric Approach: Driven by tensions with India and the Kashmir issue.
- Alliance Building: From U.S. partnerships to deeper ties with China and the Muslim world.
- Economic Dependence: Reliance on foreign aid limits autonomy.
- Regional Isolation: Persistent tensions with neighbors hinder cooperation.
- Global Realignments: Balancing relations with the U.S., China, and the Muslim world amid shifting power dynamics.